



TRUST OVER IP · ECOSYSTEM & GOVERNANCE WORKING GROUP · OCTOBER 1, 2026

Governing a registry of registries: Verana's layered governance.

Separation of powers, enumerated authority and autonomous ecosystems, for a public trust infrastructure that nobody owns.

Fabrice Rochette · Co-founder, Verana Foundation · CEO, 2060

github.com/verana-labs/verana-council-gov

An ecosystem defines what trust means in its domain.

An ecosystem is a **governed list of recognized participants** authorized to issue, verify or hold certain credentials. It publishes a governance framework, defines its credential schemas, and sets who is accredited through a participant tree. **Anyone can create one** (a sector body, a company network, a government program), **and anyone can join one, or many.**

Governance framework

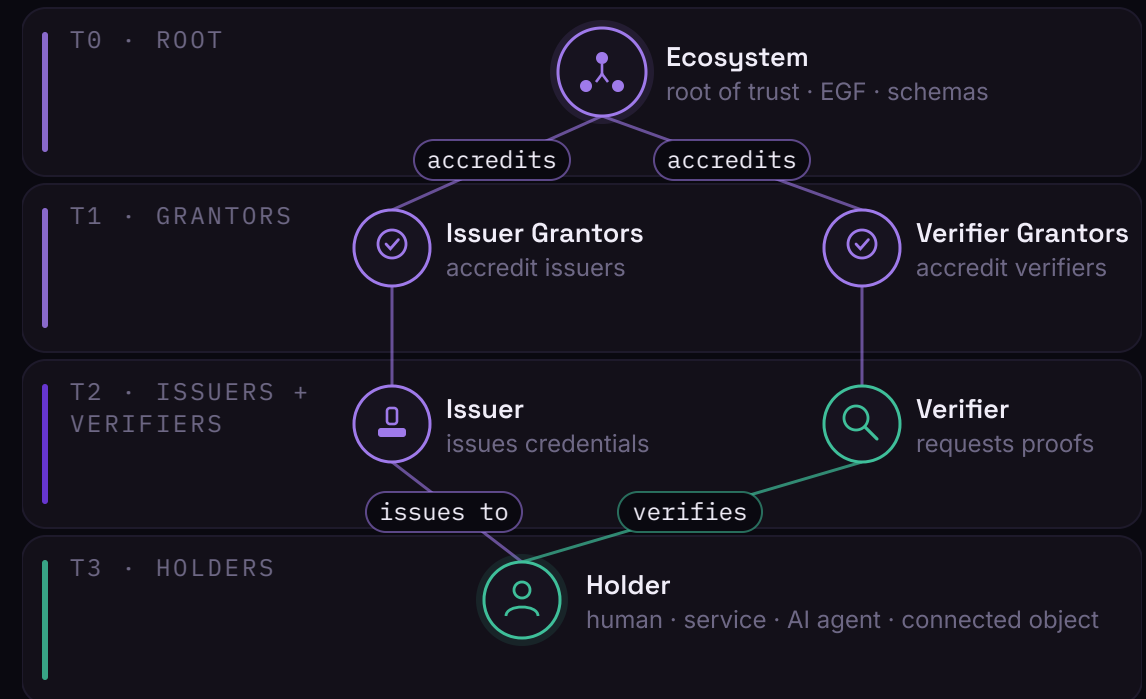
Anchored to the ecosystem's DID: versioned, resolvable, public.

Credential schemas

JSON Schemas on the registry: what each credential must contain, and how each role is onboarded, from fully open to fully governed.

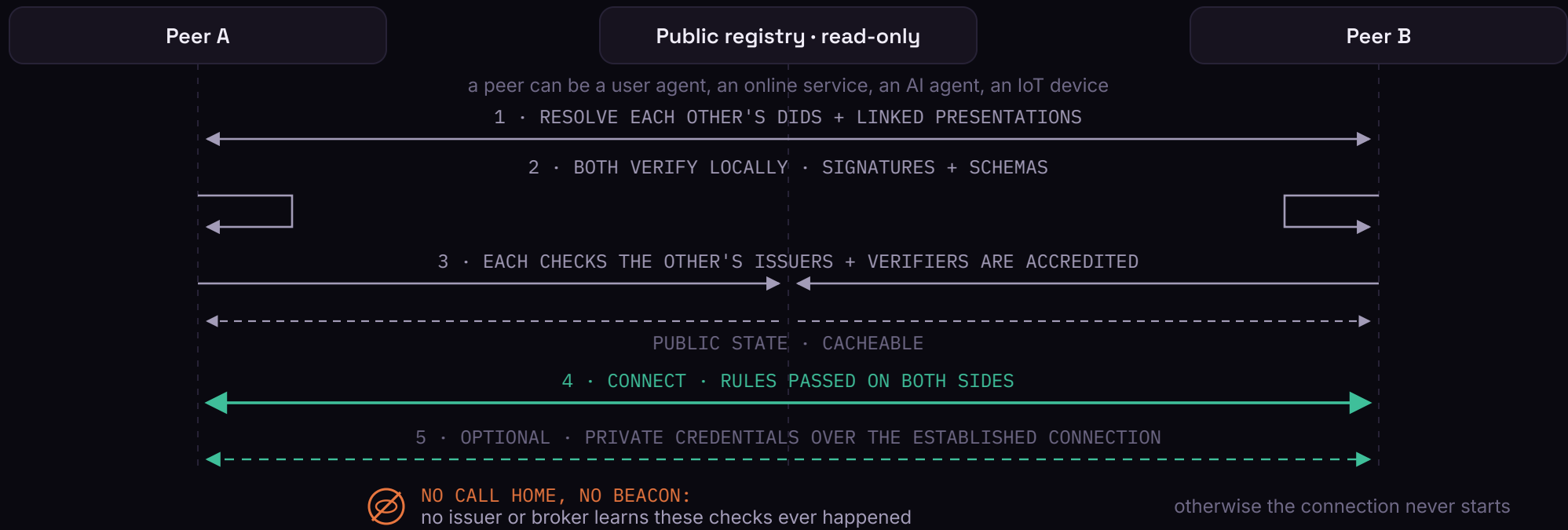
Participant tree

The ecosystem is the root and delegates to grantors, who accredit issuers and verifiers, who issue to holders. Granted, delegated and revoked in public.



Verify before you connect, in both directions.

A service is identified by a **DID**. Its DID Document exposes its endpoints (DIDComm, MCP, A2A, the web) and publishes its credentials as linked verifiable presentations: one for the service, one for the organization or person behind it. Anyone can verify the full chain against the public registry **before saying a word** to the service.



Mutual, and unobserved. Peer B verifies peer A exactly as A verifies B. Every input is public registry data or presented by the peer itself, so no issuer, broker or platform learns who verified whom.

Public proof is searchable proof.

Because credentials and accreditations are attached in public, the whole network is indexable. The **Trust Graph** is a typed index of services, agents, credentials and who accredited whom, **ranked by earned trust** instead of ad spend or SEO.

Query by proof

Find services and agents by the credentials they hold and the ecosystems that accredited them.

Only verified data enters

The resolver is the gate: an entry exists in the graph because its proof verified, and it expires with its upstream validity.

For humans and machines

APIs and an MCP server: agents resolve and choose counterparties before connecting, and every result carries verifiable provenance.

Discovery is the demand side of trust: it is why ecosystems compound.

🔍 Show me all the Verifiable Services of Acme Corp

🛡️ VERIFIED

Corporate AI Agent

AI AGENT

★★★★★

DE

Acme Corp · agentic support over MCP and DIDComm

MCPA2A

did:webvh:QmRhJB7x2...8Kpr:agent.vs.acme.example

🛡️ VERIFIED

acme.example

WEBSITE

★★★★★

DE

Acme Corp · public website service endpoint

ISO 9001 certified

did:webvh:Qm9fK2aZ...3Lmn:www.vs.acme.example

🛡️ VERIFIED

Customer Support service

SERVICE

★★★★★

DE

Acme Corp · human customer support

AG-UI

did:webvh:QmT4pL8wq...QrZ2:support.vs.acme.example

RANKED BY VERIFIABLE TRUST · NOT BY ADS OR SEO

Ecosystems that issue an ISO 42001 credential?

Which agents may verify Payment Mandate credentials?

Public infrastructure for verifiable trust, owned by no one.

Verana is a public infrastructure where anyone can:

- Create or join ecosystems
Found an ecosystem without asking anyone, or join any number of existing ones.
- Deploy verifiable services
Identify a service, an AI agent or a connected object by a DID and attach its proof in public.
- Hold roles in many ecosystems at once
As issuer, verifier or holder, each role accredited by that ecosystem under its own rules.
- Verify and discover without permission
Every claim checks against the public registry, on the client, with nobody watching.

TRUSTED

did:webvh:QmVd...8r7S:vesta.playground.testnet.verana.netwo...

SERVICE	OPERATED BY
Vesta Appliances IssuerService · badge issuance, delegated services	CH Vesta Appliances SA CHE-102.345.678 · Geneva
CREDENTIALS HELD	
ECS-Service	self-issued, under the ECS-EGF ✓
ECS-Organization	issued by Helvetia Trust Services, KYB ✓
ISO 9001	issued by NormaCert, ISO Certification Ecosystem ✓
ACCREDITED AS · PARTICIPANT ROLES	
ISSUER ECS-Badge credentials	Verana ECS Ecosystem ✓
AUTHORITY Authorized Repairer credentials	Vesta Repair Network, own ecosystem ✓

Right: one service, resolved. Vesta Appliances is a demo cast on the Verana testnet; status, Service and Organization rows resolved live on October 1, 2026 (block 5,497,856); ISO 9001 and accreditation rows follow the demo scenario.

Two entities, two roles, and a wall between them.



THE STEWARD

veranafoundation.org · a nonprofit in formation

Owns and hosts the specifications.

Stewards the open-source software.

Issues the token, owns none of it.

- Cannot govern, secure or operate the network
- Cannot run a validator node



THE GOVERNOR

veranacouncil.org · Swiss Verein in formation

Governs and secures the live network.

Authors the network and ECS governance frameworks.

25 seats, one vote each, free, every member a validator.

- Cannot change the specifications
- Cannot reach inside any ecosystem

2060 OÜ, transitional steward. Covers the Council's costs while both entities form. Every steward power sunsets on an event, and 2060 votes as one member among many.

Network governance below, sovereign ecosystems above.

ECS-EGF

the Council's own ecosystem

OWN AUTHORITY · OWN EGF
OWN TREE · OWN SANCTIONS

Health EGF

a sector body

OWN AUTHORITY · OWN EGF
OWN TREE · OWN SANCTIONS

Banking EGF

a company network

OWN AUTHORITY · OWN EGF
OWN TREE · OWN SANCTIONS

SOVEREIGN ECOSYSTEM GOVERNANCE · ANY NUMBER · PERMISSIONLESS TO CREATE

COUNCIL STOPS HERE

Network Governance Framework

the Verana Council · the commons only: validators, network parameters,
what every EGF must publish, network-level sanctions, chain evolution,
and how this document itself changes

Verifiable Trust and VPR specifications

the Verana Foundation · protocol facts prevail over every governance document

PRECEDENCE RUNS UPWARD: SPECS, THEN THE NGF, THEN EACH EGF OVER ITS OWN AGREEMENTS

NETWORK GOVERNANCE

The Council governs the commons, the substrate every ecosystem depends on. Thin, constitutional, and it never reaches inside an ecosystem.

ECOSYSTEM GOVERNANCE

Each ecosystem governs itself: its schemas, accreditations, fees, sanctions and disputes, under its own authority. The Council's ECS ecosystem is one of them, bound by the same rules.

PUBLISHED AND ANCHORED

Every framework is on-chain as versioned documents with URL and digest. The digest is canonical, active versions are immutable, past versions stay retrievable.

Conformance is recognition, never approval.

An EGF needs no Council approval to exist, publish or operate. Conformance with the Network GF is a **recognition criterion** that relying parties, wallets and the Council itself may check. An EGF may tighten the network's rules within its own domain; it may never loosen them.

Not endorsement. Creating an ecosystem, or using the Template EGF, implies no Council endorsement of the ecosystem, its authority or its participants.

Template EGF. A voluntary scaffold whose completion yields a conformant EGF by construction. Offered, never required.

Dogfood. The Council's own ECS-EGF must satisfy this chapter like any other EGF; it is the reference implementation of these fourteen items.

AUTHORITY AND SCOPE

- Identified authority with legal name and jurisdiction
- Scope of the ecosystem
- Roles in the participant-tree vocabulary

ONBOARDING AND RULES

- Onboarding per role
- Sanctions ladder with appeal to a different body
- Fee schedule, or its stated absence
- Lawful purpose

LIFECYCLE

- Amendment with notice
- Layering clause under the Network GF
- Issuer termination duties
- Document-control block

PRIVACY AND REVOCATION

- Privacy commitments
- Verified revocation requests
- Revocation availability outlives issuance

Who governs the governor, and how would you check?

The VPR specification requires it: a governance framework must define the rules of the registry, and a designated council enforces them. The Network Governance Framework is that document, written with the discipline this working group established.

- ToIP metamodel document control
- Stable requirement IDs, never renumbered
- Principles as interpretive anchors
- Controlled Documents with owners
- Initial Parameters in one annex
- RFC 2119 keywords

Deliberately thin and constitutional. Who governs, through which enumerated powers, under which principles and hard limits; what every participant owes the commons; what every EGF must contain; how validators operate; how sanctions and disputes work; how the document itself changes. Nothing else.

DOCUMENT CONTROL	
Document	Verana Network Governance Framework
Version	DRAFT 0.4
Governs	The live, validator-secured VPR chain: the constitutional floor every EGF anchored on it must respect
Governed by	The Verana Council Association (in formation)
Approved by	Pending: Incorporation General Assembly, target Q4 2026
License	CC BY-SA 4.0
Anchoring	Git history now; on-chain digest in the Council's own registry entry once the network is live

Ten interpretive anchors.

Doubt is resolved in their favor.

01 · Neutrality

The registry picks no winners; it makes authorization resolvable.

02 · Equality

One member, one vote. Economic weight and governance power are decoupled.

03 · Openness

Ecosystem creation is permissionless; all registry data is public. Validation is permissioned.

04 · Federalism

Ecosystems are autonomous. The Council governs the commons only.

05 · Transparency

A dated, public, citable record; symmetric; digest-anchored documents.

06 · Accountability

Named organizations govern and operate; each role answers for its own function.

07 · Data minimization

Identifiers, schemas, permissions, digests. Never personal data.

08 · Verify, don't trust

Every guarantee is preferentially enforced by the protocol and verifiable by anyone.

09 · Proportionality

Graduated sanctions on enumerated grounds; nobody profits from punishment.

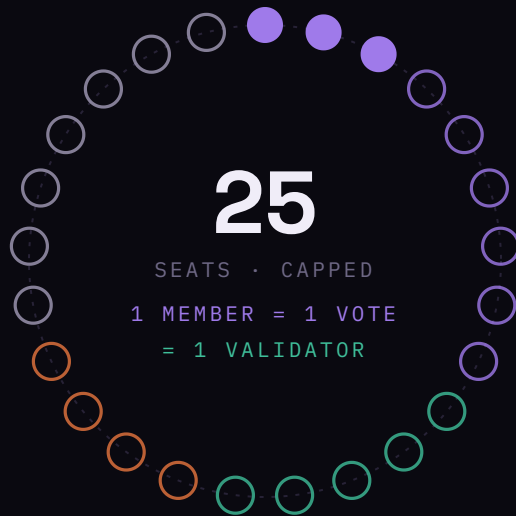
10 · Legal safety

Nothing here requires anyone to break the law.

Twin disclaimer, one. A Council seat grants no economic claim of any kind: no token allocation, no revenue share, nothing on dissolution.

Twin disclaimer, two. No economic position grants governance: no deposit, fee volume or token holding, bonded or not, converts into a vote.

A council that cannot be bought and cannot be captured.



Non-profit Swiss Verein

General Assembly supreme; small Board with zero network authority; committees advisory by default

One status, four facets

Founding Member = Verein member = voter = validator operator. Every member runs a node; only members may

Free membership

No dues, no capital contribution, no economic claim. Seats by sector, soft regional balance

Anti-capture

One seat per corporate group; change of control disclosed in 14 days; random lot if a group ends up over the cap

Two layers, one membership

Association governance under Swiss law; network governance on-chain via validator nodes. The assembly never re-votes what the chain decided

Public-Sector Observers

Governments and multilaterals attend and speak by contract, no vote, no Verein membership

Denominator discipline. Every protocol-governance change needs two-thirds of *seated* members. Recusals, absences and abstentions stay in the denominator; quorum is the passing threshold itself. 21 seated, 2 recused: 14 yes votes, or it fails.

The Council’s entire on-chain authority fits in one table.

#	GOVERNANCE-PROPOSAL-ONLY MESSAGE (VPR V5)
1	Update Corporation module parameters
2	Update Ecosystem module parameters
3	Update Credential Schema module parameters
4	Update Participant module parameters
5	Update Trust Deposit module parameters
6	Slash a trust deposit (network level)
7	Create an exchange rate
8	Enable or disable an exchange rate
9	Grant an exchange-rate authorization
10	Revoke an exchange-rate authorization

Plus: authoring its own three framework documents, and adopting network software releases. Each act needs a two-thirds vote.

CLOSURE

No other authority exists

Nothing beyond the list may be exercised, claimed or built. A new capability first needs a public amendment that enumerates it.

HARD LIMIT

No freeze, no seizure, no reversal, no deletion

The protocol has no such function and none may be added except by amendment. The only instrument against a corporation is the public, repayable withdrawal of its trust standing.

FEDERAL BOUNDARY

Never inside an ecosystem

No sanction, veto or approval of another ecosystem's framework, accreditations, fees or penalties.

Trust is earned, never bought, and money buys no vote.

TRUST UNITS

Non-transferable, decaying

A trust deposit holds Trust Units minted from a share of every fee paid or earned. They cannot be transferred, converted or withdrawn, and their value decays over time. A trust score reflects recent paid usage and fades if not maintained.

NO YIELD, NO CLAIM

Deposits earn nothing

Deposit-bound tokens fund the network at cost: validator, Council and Foundation budgets are fixed cost targets. The residual is burned. Nobody's income grows with volume.

SANCTIONS

Destroyed, never paid

Slashed trust is destroyed and the obligation is recorded at what was originally paid, not at the decayed value. Repayment restores standing. Neither the Council, a member nor a complainant ever receives sanction proceeds.

GOVERNANCE

No economic position votes

Neither a deposit, a trust score, fee volume, nor any token holding, bonded or otherwise, converts into a vote or any governance weight. The chain stays council-run; bonding is reward accounting only.

The oracle is guarded by rule. Fees settle in the native token at an on-chain rate. Every rate authorization must carry an anti-spam interval and a circuit breaker; every rate expires and fails closed; two independent operators, both Council members, per rate. A rate the protocol cannot verify is a rate nobody should trust.

Enumerated grounds, a graduated ladder, and one lever: trust standing.

Rung 1

Written warning

citing the exact requirement and evidence

Rung 2

Remediation order

30-day cure, 5 days if integrity is at stake

Rung 3

Restriction

of functions, for members

Rung 4

Suspension

for corporations: a nominal, repayable slash that makes every permission non-trustable

Rung 5

Removal for cause

members, via the assembly

Rung 6

Network slash

two-thirds proposal; graduated by amount; repay to resume

GROUND, EXHAUSTIVE

Fraud against the registry · breach of a duty this framework addresses to the party · breach of protocol-governance rules · unlawful use. Conduct governed by an EGF is sanctioned by that ecosystem alone.

DUE PROCESS

Notice and response · Sanctions Panel of unconflicted, engaged members · written reasons on the public record · appeal to a different body before execution · 60-day decision deadline · no limbo: suspensions auto-resolve.

LEGAL ORDERS

Acted on only if binding, only through the enumerated powers and the ladder, never on political or commercial pressure. Every order and act is published; sealed orders are recorded and detailed when the seal lifts. Orders to freeze funds cannot be executed: the function does not exist.

Landscape: Hedera cannot freeze accounts and may only delete illegal files · GLEIF terminates a vLEI issuer's qualification and revokes its credential · ICANN suspends and terminates registrar accreditation after notice and cure · SWIFT disconnects only on a binding EU regulation. Verana is Hedera for the chain, GLEIF and ICANN for trust.

Vary the clock, never the arithmetic.

ORDINARY PROTOCOL-GOVERNANCE CHANGE

30-day public comment · 14-day vote · two-thirds of seated · 30-day activation

EMERGENCY FAST PATH

48-hour window · same two-thirds · same denominator

Any enumerated power

a patch, a disabled oracle rate, a slash to stop an attack

Never fails outright

a fast-path vote that misses two-thirds converts into an ordinary proposal, votes kept

Ratified or it lapses

retroactive ratification within 30 days with full reasons, or the act falls and is unwound

Declared incident

the technical committee may declare one for 72 hours; members may halt; downtime is excused; no other power

Reachable signers

two emergency governance contacts per member, tested quarterly

Native to the stack

the Cosmos SDK expedited proposal: shorter window, higher threshold, auto-conversion

SOFTWARE THE COMMONS RUNS ON

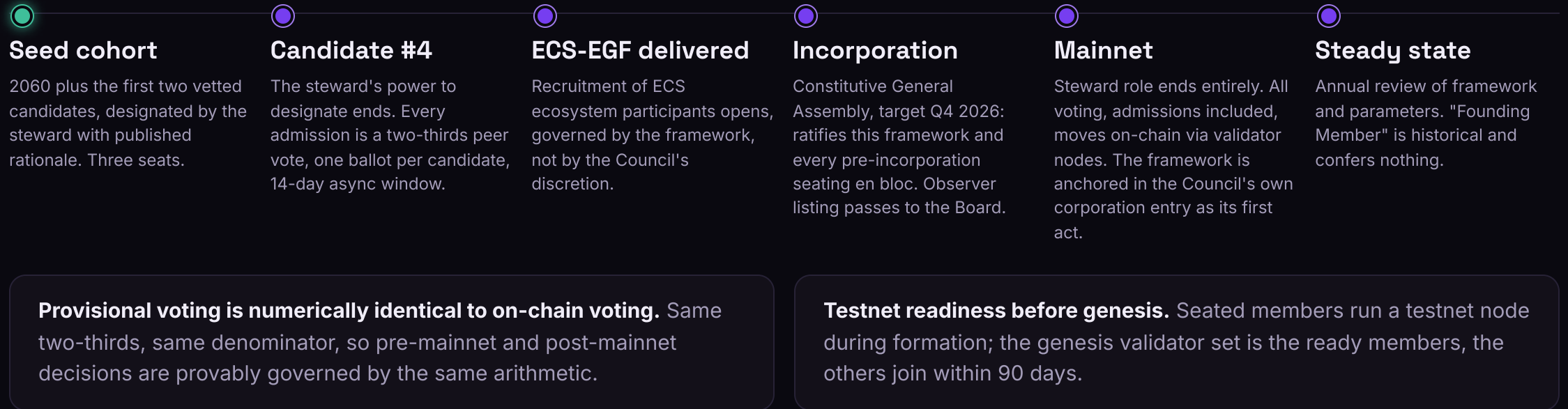
Audit all of it, or do not run it

A member may run in the validator set only software whose complete source is public under AGPL-3.0-or-later: the reference node, a modified build, or an independent implementation. Modified builds publish their source the moment they enter the set.

WHY HERE, NOT IN A LICENSE

A specification license reaches text, and the node's license reaches only its derivatives. Only a condition of validator service reaches every node. The Council adopts only releases that keep this guarantee; it does not set the license, the copyright holders do.

Steward powers that expire on events, not dates.



Everything is public, and comment is part of the process.

READ AND COMMENT

Network GF, ECS-EGF and Template EGF, DRAFT 0.4, on GitHub under CC BY-SA 4.0. Nine open decisions are flagged in the text with their alternatives; they await the Founding Members. Amendments require a 30-day public comment period open to anyone, in the repository, with a published disposition of comments before any vote.

github.com/verana-labs/verana-council-gov

SPECIFICATIONS

Verifiable Trust and Verifiable Public Registry, hosted by the Foundation, TRQP-compatible.

verana-labs.github.io/verifiable-trust-spec · verana-labs.github.io/verifiable-trust-vpr-spec

TAKE A SEAT, OR A CHAIR

Founding Member candidacies and Public-Sector Observer applications are open through Q4 2026, by non-binding expression of interest. Council membership is free.

veranacouncil.org



verana-council-gov



Verana

Thank you.

Questions, objections and precedents welcome. A governance framework is only as good as the people who tried to break it before it was ratified.

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verana.io

github.com/verana-labs/verana-council-gov



verana-council-gov